Decent Coaching Classes

VIII SB

Academic Conquest - VIII

ANSWER KEY

Subject: History (Ch. 4 & 6)Marks: 30

Q.1 (A) Correct options4

(1) (b) Bakshi Jaganbandhu Bidyadhar

(2) (c) Mumbai

(3) (a) Dadabhai Nowrojee

(4) (d) 1916

[1 mark each]

Q.1 (B) Table4

Person / Event	Related information
Partition of Bengal (1905)	Declared by Viceroy Lord Curzon (East Bengal with Muslim majority, West Bengal with Hindu majority); aim was to divide Hindus and Muslims.
Dr. Annie Besant	Started the Home Rule Movement along with Lokmanya Tilak
Morley-Minto Act (1909)	Increased Indian members in the Legislative Assembly, allowed some elected Indian representatives and gave separate electorates to Muslims.
Allan Octavian Hume	British officer who took the lead in establishing the Indian National Congress

[1 mark each]

Q.2 Short notes (any 2; 2 marks each)4

(1) Objectives of INC: to bring people of different regions together on a common platform, making them forget differences of religion, race, caste, language and territory; to understand each other's problems and views; to increase the feeling of oneness; and to make efforts for the development of the country.

(2) Home Rule Movement: Started by Dr. Annie Besant and Lokmanya Tilak during the First World War, when prices rose and the British imposed restrictions. Home Rule means self-government. They toured the country and spread the demand among common people. Tilak declared, 'Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it.'

(3) Muslim League: Alarmed by the response to the anti-partition movement, the British followed 'divide and rule'. Encouraged by Lord Minto, a committee of upper-class Muslims under Aga Khan met him, and the Muslim League was established in 1906.

Q.3 Reasons (any 2; 2 marks each)4

(1) Bengal was a very large province, so the British gave the administrative difficulty as the reason. The real aim was 'divide and rule': dividing Hindus and Muslims would weaken the freedom movement. Hence Curzon announced the partition in 1905.

(2) Congress leaders agreed on the objectives but differed on the working system. The Moderates wanted peaceful, constitutional methods while the Extremists (Lal-Bal-Pal) wanted a severe struggle. This ideological difference, which grew at the Surat session (1907) over swadeshi and boycott, split Congress into two groups.

(3) The struggle was not comprehensive (not all over India), had no central leadership, most princes stayed loyal to the British, and the rebels lacked military tactics and arms. The British had a disciplined army, modern weapons, control of transport and communication, and a favourable international situation.

Q.4 Brief answers (any 2; 3 marks each)6

(1) Political causes: After 1757 the British took over many states; Lord Dalhousie annexed the Nawab of Ayodhya's state on grounds of maladministration, and Satara, Nagpur and Jhansi by the doctrine of lapse, so Indians no longer trusted the British. Immediate cause: in 1856 sepoys were given Enfield rifles whose cartridges had to be bitten; the rumour that they were smeared with cow and pig fat hurt the religious sentiments of Hindu and Muslim sepoys.

(2) Moderates (Gokhale, Ferozshah Mehta, Surendranath Banerjee) and Extremists (Lal-Bal-Pal) – any 3 differences:

- Moderates: peaceful, constitutional methods; hoped the British would give justice. Extremists: severe struggle and mass agitation.
- Moderates sent petitions and resolutions (legislative representation, jobs for Indians, cutting military expenses); Extremists used newspapers (Kesari, Maratha), national festivals (Shiv Jayanti, Ganesh Utsav) and national education.
- Moderates tried to set aside swadeshi and boycott; Extremists supported them.
- Moderates were against armed revolution; Extremists too did not adopt armed means but wanted lakhs of people to challenge the government.

(3) Accepted unanimously at the 1906 session (President Dadabhai Nowrojee): (1) Swaraj – self-rule; (2) Swadeshi – use of Indian goods to become self-sufficient; (3) National Education; (4) Boycott – of foreign goods first, then of foreign rule, to attack the roots of British imperialism.

Q.5 Detailed answers (any 2; 4 marks each)8

(1) Outburst and spread of the struggle of 1857:

- Sepoys who refused the greased cartridges were punished. Mangal Pandey at Barrackpore shot an English officer; he was arrested and hanged, and the news spread like fire.
- The Meerut regiment joined the struggle and marched to Delhi; thousands joined on the way. They handed leadership to Mughal Emperor Bahadur Shah and proclaimed him Emperor of India.
- The revolt spread from Bihar to Rajputana – Lucknow, Allahabad, Kanpur, Banaras, Bareli, Jhansi – and later to South India.
- In Maharashtra, Chhatrapati Pratapsingh and Rango Bapuji, Chimasaheb of Kolhapur, Babasaheb Bhave and Bhagoji Naik took part; Bhills (Kajarsingh) and Shankarshah also revolted.
- Leaders: Nanasaheb Peshwa, Rani Laxmibai, Tatya Tope, Kunwar Singh, Begum Hazrat Mahal, Bakht Khan.

(2) Background of the establishment of INC:

- Centralisation of administration: uniform reforms, equality before law, roads and railways brought Indians in contact and developed nationalism.
- Economic exploitation: wealth flowed to England; cash crops, land tax and famines hurt agriculture; traditional industries declined; new taxes on the middle class – causing discontent.

- Western education: ideas of justice, liberty, equality, democracy; English became a common medium of communication.
- Study of ancient Indian history: Asiatic Society, scholars like Bhau Daji Lad and R. G. Bhandarkar made Indians proud of their heritage.
- Role of newspapers: Darpan, Hindu, Amrit Bazar Patrika, Kesari, Maratha spread political and social awakening.

(3) Anti-Partition Movement and suppression:

- Movement: protests all over India; 16 October 1905 observed as National Mourning Day; 'Vande Mataram' sung everywhere; Raksha Bandhan as a symbol of unity; students boycotted government schools and colleges. Led by Surendranath Banerjee, Anand Mohan Bose, Rabindranath Tagore. Congress grew into a national movement and the British annulled the partition.
- Suppression: public meetings banned; strict punishments, even school children beaten; restrictions on newspapers and printing presses confiscated; writers and editors jailed.
- Tilak was charged with sedition and sent to Mandalay jail for 6 years; Bipin Chandra Pal was jailed and Lala Lajpat Rai deported from Punjab. Revolutionaries then turned to firing and bomb blasts.

[Any 4 valid points / 1 mark each. Any 2 of 3 questions to be attempted.]